

THE STATE WILL CARE FOR THE VICTIMS OF INDUSTRY

THE WORKERS' ACCIDENT INSURANCE
SYSTEM (1881)



IN CONTEXT

FOCUS

Employment law

BEFORE

1838 In Prussia, legislation is passed that requires railway companies to compensate those injured at work.

1880 The UK Employers' Liability Act enables some workers to seek compensation for workplace injuries resulting from the negligence of others.

AFTER

1897 In the UK, the Workmen's Compensation Act introduces a system of no-fault compensation for industrial injuries.

1911 Germany expands the workers' insurance scheme to cover nearly all workers for death, disability, and sickness.

1935 In the US, a system of work-based health insurance is introduced with the Social Security Act.

As the Industrial Revolution accelerated across 19th-century Europe and the US, more and more people moved from farming to employment in manufacturing and construction. The mechanization of agriculture and industry made work more hazardous and injuries increasingly common. Social reformers saw that a system was required to provide compensation for work-related injuries and deaths.

From the mid-19th century, in Britain and other industrialized countries, aid organizations called "mutual" or "friendly" societies emerged. These allowed groups